

Canon MP-730

Featured to the boot

The MP-730 from Canon is bulky, but its proportions are concealed by clever design—rounded corners and detachable paper trays. The device we reviewed had a twin-tone grey finish. Ergonomically, the MP-730 has the best interface among the MFDs we tested. The exception is the memory card reader, which, we feel, is positioned awkwardly, just beneath the operating panel.



The fax unit, still lacks certain features provided by stand-alone fax machines such as synchronising fax numbers. The unit can connect to a PC via the provided USB 2.0 compliant USB port, but does not include a USB cable.

In the speed test it was able to print our test text document in 19 seconds—pretty good for an MFD. The printer unit is also decent—it prints both text and images fast. On the scanning front, the MP-730 is quite fast on lower resolutions, but as you go higher on resolution, the time increases considerably. The scan quality is average, with good details and colour reproduction—but the image is overly bright. Copying quality is excellent, though it takes a little long.

Coming to cost per page, the MP-730 comes out tops, with B&W pages working out to a little under Rs 2.50, and colour pages to Rs 2.25. Overall, this is a good product with features, functionality and performance blended into a single appealing package that is hard to resist.

Canon MP-730		C-
Performance	    	
Features	    	
Ease of use	    	
Value for money	    	

Price: Rs 35,000
Pros: Lot of features; easy to use; low running cost
Cons: Bulky design

Epson CX5100

The shotgun device

The CX-5100 is one of the two MFDs that Epson has selected from its kitty for the Indian market. Though the CX-5100 is termed a MFD, one needs to note that it does not integrate stand-alone fax functionality. It comes with the printer, scanner and copier units in a single package, with software-driven faxing capability. Another sorely-missed feature is the absence of a memory card reader with which you print photographs directly from the card reader, without the



need for a PC. One good feature, is the four separate colour cartridges—you save money because you can just buy the one cartridge that gets over, say the red one.

The CX-5100 makes up some lost ground by logging some of the best scores in the speed-print-

ing department. In the image speed test, the CX-5100 took just 141 seconds to print our photograph, and that means it completes the job 20 seconds faster than any standalone printer we've tested so far.

It seems Epson has tweaked the paper pickup mechanism quite a bit, as is evident from the amount of noise it makes when loading the paper—this earned it the nickname ‘shotgun’. On the quality front, the CX-5100 performs decently in the image test and brilliantly in the text quality test. In the scanning department, though, the Shotgun lost out completely, and came in last in the speed tests—but logged decent quality. In the cost per page analysis, it stood second.

Overall, this is a good product that's largely let down by the absence of integrated fax capability—and an unrealistic price of Rs. 22,500. We think Epson needs to work on its pricing policy.

Epson CX5100		C+
Performance	    	
Features	    	
Ease of use	    	
Value for money	    	

Price: Rs 22,500
Pros: Very fast printing
Cons: Low on features; expensive

HP PSC 2210 All-in-one

HP's trump card, the all rounder

The HP 2210 looks like a scanner placed on top of their DJ-5550 DeskJet printer—very uninspired. The wedge-shaped scanner bed does not feature a transportation lock, so careful handling is required.



The HP 2210 packs in all the features you can expect of an MFD.

The PSC 2210 is USB 2.0 compliant, and therefore can be connected to a full-speed USB port on your PC. A one-touch scan-to-mail button further simplifies your life.

It took a long time to print out our text document, and clocked 30 seconds. It took nearly 5 minutes in the image-printing speed test—but output superb print quality.

When an image was scanned at 600 dpi, the 2210 clocked the fastest time (93 seconds). In the scan quality test the 2210 again showed its mettle with good contrast and colour accuracy; and in the colour deviation and uniformity test, no other MFD comes quite close to the 2210's performance.

Overall, this is again a great product—another all-rounder. Whether it's printing, scanning, copying or faxing, you can expect a good performance. The only area where the 2210 loses out at the MP-730, is the sheer features that the latter offers. But the price difference between these is staggering too—the MP-730 costs over Rs 30,000, whereas the 2210 costs just Rs. 13,999. Comparing them would be an injustice to both. All kudos to HP for packing this little beauty with enough punch to be a beast.

HP PSC 2210 All-in-One

B+

HP PSC 2210 All-in-One		B+
Performance	    	
Features	    	
Value for money	    	
Ease of use	    	

Price: Rs 13,999
Pros: Great print and scan quality
Cons: Lacks in the faxing department